

Subject Code	ENGL5048
Subject Title	Communication and Health in the Age of AI
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	N/A
Objectives	To develop students' awareness of the nature of communication, including AI-mediated communication, in the health domain, drawing from applied linguistics and germane disciplines, such as, psychology, public health, and sociology. To address broad currents in health communication and provide a cultural lens for addressing these. To equip students with tools to understand communication in applied health settings, including among families, patients, health providers, and with respect to public health messaging, and will provide approaches for applied interventions in these areas, including addressing the increasing influence of GenAI.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: - Identify the key components of communication in health and analyse the salient processes and factors involved; - Critique and reflect on these from a global perspective with special emphasis on the multilevel aspects of communication, including AI-mediated communication; - Relate health communication to attitudes, beliefs, and decision-making processes by both lay public and health professionals; - Identify and discuss relevant theories and research on health communication and AI literacy in health that can inform professional practice;
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	The broad areas that the subject will address include: - Health Communication and Developments in GenAI - Health Communication in Interpersonal and Family Contexts - Patient-Provider Communication - Stigma and Health Communication - Health Literacy and AI - Media and Health Communication - Misinformation and Conspiracies in Health Communication - Campaigns and Interventions in Health Communication - Culture and Global Health Communication

	• Ethical Issues in Health Communication in Health Communication • Research about Health Communication																																																						
Teaching/Learning Methodology	This elective subject presents a broad survey of health communication in traditional and AI contexts. Students are encouraged to make connections to other subjects they will have completed in the MA. Lectures are used to bring class members onto a similar footing with core knowledge from applied linguistics, psychological, and social sciences disciplines, in relation to communication. Active learning is heavily emphasized. Students are encouraged to participate actively in class and in any online discussion activities. Students are expected to take responsibility for self-study, including the reading of books, articles, and reports relevant to the subject to prepare for the assessments																																																						
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="6">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th></th><th></th></tr><tr><td>1. Participation</td><td>10%</td><td></td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2. Quiz 1</td><td>10%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3. Quiz 2</td><td>25%</td><td></td><td></td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>4. Practical Assignment</td><td>55%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>100 %</td><td colspan="6"></td></tr></table> Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: Online discussion participation (20%) Most weeks of the subject will contain discussion topics selected by the lecturer that are connected to the relevant lectures. Students will present their views via an online forum and are encouraged to demonstrate critical thinking by applying evidence gained from subject materials and readings and responding to and critiquing each other’s contributions, including personal reflections where appropriate. Quizzes (10% + 25%) These two items will be spaced early and later in the semester, respectively, and questions will assess understanding of key concepts and theories as presented in the relevant weeks of class. Students will need to make reference to either or both of the materials presented in class and on set readings for these topics. The early quiz will be more formative and will provide an important	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)						a	b	c	d			1. Participation	10%		✓	✓	✓			2. Quiz 1	10%	✓	✓					3. Quiz 2	25%			✓	✓			4. Practical Assignment	55%	✓	✓	✓				Total	100 %						
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4. Practical Assignment	55%	✓	✓	✓																																																			
Total	100 %																																																						

	feedback to help students understand their course participation and the later quiz will be a summative piece. Practical assignment (55%) This assignment will consist of a report of 2000 words of a practical application of health communication, such as interviewing a senior family member, or collecting information about public health messaging. Individual topics will be developed in consultation with the instructor. Students will make a brief presentation of their report in later weeks of class and will provide a writeup following a structured format to fulfil the requirements of this assessment item. This piece will be an opportunity for students will to address a key question relevant to health communication locally and thereby to demonstrate their critical and analytical thinking. Students are encouraged to take a comparative, global perspective with respect to Hong Kong and the Mainland and to base their analyses on a range of theoretical and applied sources relating to health communication.	
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:	
	▪ Lectures	39 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Private study	81 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	120 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Recommended references Instructors will also set specific readings for classes and activities as required Afifi, T., Collins, N., Rand, K., Otmar, C., Mazur, A., Dunbar, N. E., Fujiwara, K., Harrison, & Logsdon, R. (2022). Using virtual reality to improve the quality of life of older adults with cognitive impairments and their family members who live at a distance. <i>Health Communication</i>, 38(9), 1904–1915. https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2022.2040170 Berkman, N. D., Davis, T. C., & McCormack, L. (2010). Health literacy: What is it? <i>Journal of Health Communication</i>, 15(sup. 2), 9–19. https://doi.org/10.1080/10810730.2010.499985 Brookes, G., & Hunt, D. (Eds.). (2021). <i>Analysing Health Communication: Discourse Approaches</i>. Palgrave Macmillan. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-68184-5 Enea, V., Eisenbeck, N., Carreno, D. F., Douglas, K. M., Sutton, R. M., Agostini, M., ... Leander, N. P. (2022). Intentions to be vaccinated against COVID-19: The role of prosociality and conspiracy beliefs across 20 countries. <i>Health Communication</i>, 38(8), 1530–1539. https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2021.2018179 Jones, C. L., Jensen, J. D., Scherr, C. L., Brown, N. R., Christy, K., & Weaver, J. (2014). The Health Belief Model as an explanatory framework in communication research: exploring parallel, serial, and moderated mediation. <i>Health Communication</i>, 30(6), 566–576. https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2013.873363 Kim, D. D., & Kreps, G. L. (Eds.). (2022). <i>Global Health Communication for Immigrants and Refugees: Cases, Theories, And Strategies</i>. Routledge.	

	Harrington, N. G., & Record, R. A. (2024). <i>Health Communication: Research and Practice for A Diverse and Changing World</i> (2nd ed.). Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003214458 Jackson, S. R., Yu, P., Armany, D., Occhipinti, S., Chambers, S., Leslie, S., Patel, M. (2024), eHealth literacy in prostate cancer: A systematic review. <i>Patient Education and Counseling</i>, 123, 108193. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pec.2024.108193 Jauch, M., Occhipinti, S., O'Donovan, A., Clough, B. (2024). A qualitative study into the relative stigmatization of mental illness by mental health professionals. <i>Qualitative Health Research</i>. Online first. https://dx.doi.org/10.1177/10497323241238618 Makkizadeh F. & Ebrahimi F. (2022). Theme trends and knowledge structure on health communication: Bibliometric analysis in PubMed database, <i>Informatics in Medicine Unlocked</i>, 32, 101033. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.imu.2022.101033 Occhipinti, S., Dunn, J., O'Connell, D.L., Garvey, G., Valery, P.C., Ball, D., Fong, K.M., Vinod, S., Chambers, S.K. (2018). Lung Cancer Stigma Across the Social Network: Patients' and Caregivers' Perspectives. <i>Journal of Thoracic Oncology</i>, 13(10),1443-1453. https://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.jtho.2018.06.015 Occhipinti, S., Laurie, K., Hyde, M. K., Martin, S., Oliffe, J., Wittert, G., & Chambers, S. K. (2019). Measuring masculinity in men with chronic disease. <i>American Journal of Men's Health</i>, 13(4), 1-7. https://doi.org/10.1177/1557988319859706 Pun, J. K.-H. (2023). <i>The Role of Language in Eastern and Western Health Communication</i>. Routledge. Thompson, T. L., Harrington, N. G. (Eds.). (2022). <i>The Routledge Handbook of Health Communication</i> (3rd edition.). Routledge. Turnbull, M. & Reich, A. (2023). Using Foucault to (re)think localisation in chronic disease care: Insights for nursing practice. <i>Nursing Philosophy</i>, 24(1), e12392. https://doi.org/10.1111/nup.12392 Turnbull, M., Yu, C., & Wu, X. I. (2023). Practitioner accounts of end-of-life communication in Hong Kong, Mainland China and Taiwan: A systematic review. <i>Patient Education and Counseling</i>, 106, 31-41. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pec.2022.10.007 Werder, O. (2024). <i>Transformational Health Communication: A New Perspective on Healthcare and Prevention</i>. Springer Nature. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-99-9606-3 Wellman, M. L., Holton, A. E., & Kaphingst, K. A. (2022). Previvorship posting: why breast cancer previvors share their stories on social media. <i>Health Communication</i>, 38(11), 2441–2449. https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2022.2074780 Zhang, X., Li, L., Zhang, Q., Le, L. H., & Wu, Y. (2023). Physician empathy in doctor-patient communication: A systematic review. <i>Health Communication</i>, 39(5), 1027–1037. https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2023.2201735
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